communication flow. Thus, the communication flow within the organisation may be inter-scalar when two parties are at the different managerial levels or inter-scalar when they are at the same hierarchical level - this is also known as horizontal communication. The inter-scalar communication may again be classified as downward, when the message flows from the higher to lower level, or upward when it is the other way round.

i). Downward Communication

Downward Communication within the organization flows from a superior either in the same line of command or in the different one It stands out as a great force for controlling influencing and indicating activities of organization members. Communication in this category includes (1) orders and instructions about job, (2) directions about understanding of job and its relationships with other jobs, (3) organisational policies and procedures, (4) feedback of subordinates' performance, (5) reprimands, criticisms, etc., and (6) questions inviting upward communication. In the organisation, people at lower levels, have a high degree of fear and respect towards such communication, which leads to high degree of acceptance of such communication. Coordination, distortion and resistance are three important problems that characterize the downward communication process.

ii). Upward Communication

Upward communication flows from a subordinate position to a superior position. It includes information about (i) subordinates' work performance (ii) problems relating to work, (iii) performance appraisal of their subordinates, (iv)feedback of understanding of orders, instructions, etc., (v) clarifications of orders, etc., (vi) opinions, attitude, feeling, etc., (vii) procedures, methods, practices followed in doing the work, (viii) criticisms, (ix) new ideas and suggestions, and (x) personal and family problems, Upward communication is more susceptible to various obstructions and bottlenecks discussed later on, because of its special nature. Managers, often times, fail to realize that upward communication cannot be taken for granted, as is the case with downward communication. This is so because, unlike downward communication, upward communication is devoid of any support of managerial hierarchy. On the contrary, it has to flow in a direction directly opposite to the flow of official authority, from the dependent subordinates to the superiors or whom they (subordinates) are directly or indirectly dependent for the satisfaction for their needs. As such, there is a strong possibility of upward information being distorted or coloured. It is interesting to note that coloring takes place primarily in upward communication, because this direction of flow carries managerial control information.

iii). Horizontal Communication

It is the flow of information between persons of the same hierarchical level. Formal organisation provides for horizontal communication by means of right of persons at any level to consult or work with others at the same level. Communication among peers, in addition to

providing task coordination, also furnishes emotional and social support to the individual. Horizontal communication is impeded in the organisation that overstresses functional departmentalization. The creation of functional departments of units creates problems of coordination and communication between members of such units. Some companies develop committee structure near the top level of the organisation to assist the chief executive in achieving coordination and better horizontal communication in terms of control function in the organisation. Horizontal communication, if in operation at various levels in an organisation, is a real check on the power of the top leaders.

4.2 BARRIERS TO COMMUNICATION

In between the communicator and the receiver, certain barriers considerably affect the quality of information transmission. Some of the major barriers are discussed below.

1) Expression

2) Interpretation

3) Response

These are the crucial points in communication. If the expression is not clear, the interpretation will be inaccurate and the response improper, thus one's effort to communicate will not succeed. In other words, if the source does not have adequate or clear information if the message is not encoded fully, accurately, effectively in transmittable signs; if these are not transmitted fast enough and accurately enough, despite interference and competition, to the desired receiver; if the message is not decoded in a pattern that corresponds to the encoding; and finally if the destination is unable to handle the decoded message so as to produce the desired response, then, obviously, the system is working at less than top efficiency.

Other barriers in Communication

1. **Filtering**

Because of the many other concerns which constantly influence our ability to concentrate on what we hear, the average listener will normally "filter out" certain things that he hears. They will simply ignore a point made by the speaker, as though it had never been presented. This can be deliberate or unintended.

2. **Distortion**

For the same reason, the human mind can also distort what it hears. It is an unconscious process. Every person tends to remember best what agrees with his own values.

3. **Communication Overload**

Our minds can receive and retain only a limited amount of information without showing strain. This is called channel capacity. This ability can vary with different audiences. Overloading the system will in effect below the mental fuse and defensively shut down the communication process.

4. **Absence of Redundancy**

It is the use of repetition. Even under the best condition an audience can have problems grasping or fully appreciating the significance of something new which has been presented to them. By repeating it, or by illustrating it or by restating the same point in different ways a speaker can make it easier for an audience to understand and retain the information passed on by the speaker.

Barriers to Communication in an organization

- Lack of communication policy
- Past attitude and lapses on the part of the management to keep promises. This gives rise to credibility gap.
- Legal limitations
- Unfavourable climate
- Poor listening
- Poor strategy of communication
- Allowing the 'grape vine' to go wild
- Over confidence in one's ability to know what others are thinking
- Underestimating the intelligence and overestimating the fund of knowledge of the listeners
- Lack of clarity
- Too many items in the same message
- Too many links in the circulation chain resulting in loss of details and in distortion.
- Lack of motivation
- Failure to seek an instant response and lack of follow up
- Neglect in the use or misuse of available med

Lesson 5

PRINCIPLES OF EXTENSION EDUCATION

3.1 Introduction

The philosophical background and existing reality suggest that extension should be treated as planned educational activity for overall development of farmer stakeholders with the use of science and technology. No extension professional can afford to treat it as a random affair. The challenge of extension professionals in rural areas calls for inclusion of participatory approaches in planning, executing and evaluating extension works. It demands sensitivity and inter-disciplinary orientation on the part of extension educators to ward off untoward effects. Before we discuss the principle of extension education, we have to understand the meaning of principle. A common definition of a Principle is a fundamental truth and a settled rule of action.

Principle is a statement of policy to guide decisions and actions in a proper manner.

The extension work is based upon some working principles and the knowledge of these principles is necessary for extension personnel. Some of these principles, as related to extension education, are mentioned below:

3.1.1 Principle of people's need and interest

Extension work must be based on the needs & interests of the people. These needs & interests differ from individual to individual, from village to village, from block to block, from district to district; therefore, there cannot be one programme for all people.

3.1.2 Principle of grass root level organisation

A group of rural people in local community should sponsor extension work. The programme should fit in with the local conditions. The aim of organising the local group is to demonstrate the value of the new practices or programmes so that more & more people would participate.

3.1.3 Principle of cultural difference

Extension work is based on the cultural background of the people with whom the work is done. Improvement can only begin from the level of the people where they are. This means that the Extension professionals has to know the level of the knowledge, & the skills of the people, methods & tools used by them, their customs, traditions, beliefs, values, etc. before starting the extension programme.

3.1.4 Principle of cultural change

Extension education starts with what the learner knows, has and thinks. With this in mind and with an attitude of respect towards clients, the extension professionals must seek to discover and understand the limitations, taboo and the cultural values related to each phase of programme so that an acceptable approach could be selected in the locality

3.1.5 Principle of cooperation and people's participation

Extension is a co-operative venture. It is a joint democratic enterprise in which rural people co-operate with their village, block & state officials to pursue a common cause. Ultimately without the cooperation of people the work cannot be successful and desired result cannot be achieved. The first task of extension education is the cooperation of people and their participation in work. Extension helps people to help themselves. Good extension work is directed towards assisting rural families to work out their own problems rather than giving them ready-made solutions. Actual participation & experience of people in these programmes creates self-confidence in them and also they learn more by doing. People should realise that the task of extension education is their own task. Participation in extension work generates confidence among people for the work. It is not essential that all the members of the society should participate but Extension professionals should try for maximum participation of people.

3.1.6 Principle of applied science and democratic approach

Extension education is based upon democratic principles. It is based on discussions and suggestions. Discussions are held with the people on actual field conditions, so that they participate in work. Extension professionals provide practical look to the scientific inventions so that farmers can easily adopt them on their farm.

3.1.7 Principle of learning by doing

According to this principle, farmers are encouraged to learn by doing the work themselves and by participating in it. When a person does a work, he gains practical knowledge and experiences the difficulties. Extension professionals are able to understand the problems and provide proper guidance to the farmers and thus, they are able to receive proper information/feedback.

3.1.8 Principle of trained specialists

It is very difficult that extension personnel should be knowledgeable about all problems. Therefore, it is necessary that specialists should impart training to the farmers from time to time.

3.1.9 Principle of adaptability in use of extension teaching methods

People differ from each other, one group differs from another group and conditions also differ from place to place. An extension programme should be flexible, so that necessary changes can be made whenever needed, to meet the varying conditions. Extension professionals should have knowledge of extension methods so that they can select proper method according to the condition. Teaching methods should be flexible so that they can be properly applied on people according to their age groups, educational background, economic standard and gender. In extension education, two or more methods should be applied according to the principle of adaptability.

3.1.10 Principle of leadership

Extension work is based on the full utilisation of local leadership. The selection & training of local leaders to enable them to help in carrying out extension work is essential to the success of the programme. People have more faith in local leaders & they should be used to put across a new idea so that it is accepted with the least resistance.

3.1.11 Principle of whole family

Extension work will have a better chance of success if the extension professionals have a whole-family approach instead of piecemeal approach or separate & uninterested approach. Extension work is, therefore, for the whole family, i.e. for male, female and children.

3.1.12 Principle of evaluation

Extension is based upon the methods of science, and it needs constant evaluation. The effectiveness of the work is measured in terms of the changes brought about in the knowledge, skill, attitude, and adoption behaviour of the people, not merely in terms of achievement of physical targets.

3.1.13 Principle of satisfaction

The end-product of the effort of extension teaching is the satisfaction that comes to the farmer and his family members as the result of solving a problem, meeting a need, acquiring a new skill or some other changes in behaviour. Satisfaction is the key to success in extension work. *A satisfied stakeholder is the best advertisement*.